Question:

Shock causes:

Answer Choices:

A. Stagnant hypoxia

B. Anemic hypoxia

C. Hypoxic hypoxia

D. Histotoxic hypoxia

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

To analyze the causes of shock, we need to consider the underlying pathophysiology. Shock is a complex condition characterized by inadequate perfusion of vital organs, leading to tissue hypoxia. The primary cause of shock is often multifactorial, but it can be categorized into several types based on the underlying mechanism.

A. Stagnant hypoxia refers to a condition where there is inadequate blood flow to the tissues, leading to hypoxia. This can be caused by various factors such as cardiac arrest, cardiac tamponade, or severe hypovolemia. Stagnant hypoxia is a common cause of shock, particularly in conditions where there is a significant impairment of cardiac function.

B. Anemic hypoxia occurs when there is a decrease in the amount of functional hemoglobin in the blood, leading to inadequate oxygen delivery to the tissues. This can be caused by conditions such as anemia, carbon monoxide poisoning, or severe hemolysis. While anemic hypoxia can contribute to shock, it is less common as a primary cause compared to stagnant hypoxia.

C. Hypoxic hypoxia refers to a condition where there is a decrease in the partial pressure of oxygen in the arterial blood, leading to inadequate oxygen delivery to the tissues. This can be caused by conditions such as high-altitude exposure, respiratory diseases, or respiratory depression. Hypoxic hypoxia is a common cause of shock in conditions where there is a significant impairment of respiratory function.

D. Histotoxic hypoxia occurs when there is a direct impairment of cellular respiration, leading to inadequate energy production. This can be caused by conditions such as cyanide poisoning, carbon monoxide poisoning, or severe liver dysfunction. Histotoxic hypoxia is a less common cause of shock compared to stagnant hypoxia.

Considering the above explanations, stagnant hypoxia is a primary cause of shock, as it directly impairs blood flow to the tissues, leading to inadequate oxygen delivery. This is a common mechanism in various conditions, including cardiac arrest, cardiac tamponade, and severe hypovolemia.

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<answer>

A. Stagnant hypoxia

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